
BURKE LAKEFRONT ENERGY CAMPUS

Cleveland, Ohio

AI Workload Tenants & Corporate Relocation Targets

Prepared for the City of Cleveland

May 2026

Executive Summary

The Burke Lakefront Energy Campus represents a generational opportunity for the City of Cleveland to become the preeminent AI infrastructure hub of the Great Lakes region. By combining small modular reactor (SMR) nuclear power, Lake Erie free cooling, green hydrogen production, and a world-class research university corridor, the campus offers every competitive advantage that AI-driven companies require — at a cost structure no coastal market can match.

This brief identifies 20 priority targets across five tiers: hyperscale data center operators, healthcare AI companies, industrial AI platforms, energy and climate AI firms, and corporate headquarters seeking Midwest AI hubs. Together, these companies represent tens of billions in capital investment, thousands of permanent high-wage jobs, and a self-reinforcing technology ecosystem that compounds in value over decades.



Why Burke Wins the Competition

Burke Lakefront is not simply another data center site. It is the only campus in North America that combines all five of the following critical infrastructure advantages simultaneously:

Advantage	Strategic Value
SMR Nuclear Power	24/7 carbon-free baseload from small modular reactors — the anchor energy source hyperscalers are actively paying to secure. No grid dependency, no intermittency.
Lake Erie Free Cooling	Virtually unlimited freshwater cooling reduces data center Power Usage Effectiveness (PUE) to 1.03–1.05 — a 25–35% compute efficiency advantage over air-cooled competitors.
Green Hydrogen Production	On-site PEM electrolysis and FastOx gasification produce green hydrogen and syngas, enabling co-location of energy AI, industrial AI, and process heat applications.
Research University Corridor	Case Western Reserve, Cleveland Clinic, Tri-C, and Cleveland State are all within 5 km — the deepest healthcare AI and energy engineering talent pipeline in the Midwest.
Port & Offshore Wind Access	Direct Lake Erie frontage enables hydrogen marine bunkering and Icebreaker Wind cable landing, creating a multi-modal clean energy hub with no equivalent in the region.

TIER 1 HYPERSCALE DATA CENTER TENANTS

Primary power consumers and financial anchors of the campus. Burke's lake cooling + SMR baseload delivers unmatched cost efficiency.

#	Company	Why They Are a Target	Burke Campus Hook
1	Microsoft Azure	Committed to nuclear-powered data centers nationally; active Ohio infrastructure investor; existing Cleveland Clinic AI Alliance relationship.	<i>SMR baseload + lake cooling matches their Susquehanna model. Cleveland Clinic partnership is a built-in AI workload anchor.</i>
2	Oracle / Stargate	Stargate platform (with OpenAI and SoftBank) announced an Ohio location; Oracle simultaneously planning three SMR integrations for data centers.	<i>Burke's SMR-plus-lake-cooling profile is precisely the built-in energy site Stargate needs for next-gen inference campuses.</i>
3	Equinix	Most aggressive colocation provider pursuing SMR deals globally; hybrid retail/hyperscale model serves 270+ sites.	<i>Would operate as Burke's campus colocation manager — subleasing compute to dozens of enterprise AI tenants without requiring individual tenant recruitment.</i>
4	Amazon Web Services	\$23B Ohio expansion underway; nuclear PPA precedent at Susquehanna; X-energy SMR commitment signals active search for additional Ohio nuclear sites.	<i>Lake Erie cooling is operationally identical to their Susquehanna river-cooled campus. Burke is the logical northern Ohio anchor.</i>
5	Google Cloud	Planning three separate 600 MW nuclear projects for data centers; 500 MW Kairos Power SMR fleet deal signed.	<i>Burke's integrated SMR design and Great Lakes research corridor directly match Google's preference for purpose-built nuclear campuses.</i>

TIER 2 HEALTHCARE AI COMPANIES

Cleveland's single greatest competitive advantage. No city has Cleveland Clinic + University Hospitals + Case Western + IBM Quantum on one corridor.

#	Company	Why They Are a Target	Burke Campus Hook
6	Palantir Technologies	Six-year Cleveland Clinic partnership developing AI-driven Virtual Command Center for patient demand management — described as 'transformative' by Clinic CEO.	<i>Burke data center campus (5 km from Clinic) gives Palantir low-latency infrastructure to run production Clinic workloads on-premises. Cleveland office expansion follows compute.</i>
7	IBM (Quantum + Watson Health)	IBM Quantum System One already installed at Cleveland Clinic — world's first quantum computer dedicated to healthcare research.	<i>Burke campus compute gives IBM the infrastructure to expand Cleveland health AI operations far beyond the single Quantum system on-site.</i>
8	G42 (Abu Dhabi AI)	Sovereign AI investor with Cleveland Clinic joint task force; actively seeking U.S. data center anchor sites with clean energy profiles.	<i>Burke's nuclear-clean power satisfies G42's ESG mandates. Cleveland Clinic partnership makes Burke the natural U.S. hub for their healthcare AI compute.</i>
9	Ambience, Akasa, Bayesian	Three co-development AI partners of Cleveland Clinic, each financially backed by the health system; co-designing tools with 20,000+ Clinic nurses and physicians.	<i>These companies need low-latency compute proximity to Clinic's clinical data. Burke colocation is the natural production inference home.</i>
10	Tennr	\$101M Series C in June 2025; \$605M valuation; former Cleveland Clinic Chief Innovation Officer joined as CMO. Cleveland's nearest healthcare AI unicorn candidate.	<i>Burke campus compute accelerates Tennr's path to national scale, with Cleveland as declared headquarters and Clinic as flagship customer.</i>

TIER 3 INDUSTRIAL & ADVANCED MANUFACTURING AI

Cleveland's steel, chemicals, and manufacturing base is these companies' core customer base — beyond data center access.

#	Company	Why They Are a Target	Burke Campus Hook
11	Rockwell Automation	World's largest industrial automation company; rapidly building AI-driven manufacturing platforms for steel, chemicals, and automotive — all core Ohio industries.	<i>Burke campus AI research node, co-located with CWRU engineering, accelerates industrial AI product development for the Ohio manufacturing base.</i>
12	Siemens Digital Industries	Industrial AI and digital twin platforms directly applicable to Cleveland Cliffs steel operations, rolling mills, and scrap processing.	<i>A Burke campus research presence tied to CWRU materials engineering and live Cleveland Cliffs deployments is uniquely compelling.</i>
13	Procter & Gamble AI Labs	Ohio-headquartered; actively building proprietary AI capability; cited as Great Lakes AI Week leader moving from pilots to production.	<i>Burke campus AI research center adjacent to CWRU provides talent pipeline and compute without requiring HQ relocation.</i>
14	Sherwin-Williams AI Division	Cleveland-headquartered; global coatings leader investing in AI-driven supply chain, formulation, and quality control platforms.	<i>Burke campus positions Sherwin-Williams as Cleveland's first corporate AI campus anchor, accelerating CWRU partnership and talent retention.</i>
15	SparkCognition / C3.ai	Industrial AI for energy, manufacturing, and infrastructure; directly aligned with Burke campus's own operations across nuclear, hydrogen, and grid management.	<i>Burke is a unique live testbed — nuclear + hydrogen + data center + grid — unavailable at any other site in the country.</i>

TIER 4 ENERGY & CLIMATE AI COMPANIES

A fast-growing sector that barely existed in 2022. Burke is the only campus combining nuclear, hydrogen, wind, and waste-to-energy in one physical site.

#	Company	Why They Are a Target	Burke Campus Hook
16	Mainspring / Form Energy / Antora	Long-duration energy storage and grid optimization AI companies needing real-world grid data at scale from multi-source microgrids.	<i>Burke's SMR + KARNO + offshore wind + electrolyzer + FastOx produces the richest energy systems dataset in the Midwest. Campus access is a paid research partnership.</i>
17	Gradient Energy / Envision Energy	AI-driven grid management platforms for distributed generation environments; rapid growth as U.S. grid complexity increases.	<i>Burke's island-capable IEEE 1547 Category III microgrid is a living lab. Campus research presence gives credibility with utilities nationwide.</i>
18	Exelon / FirstEnergy AI Labs	FirstEnergy already serves the Cleveland lakefront corridor and prefers negotiated terms with large data center developers over standard tariffs.	<i>An on-campus FirstEnergy AI research lab focused on grid integration of distributed nuclear and hydrogen assets positions them as a national utility AI leader.</i>

TIER 5 CORPORATE HQ RELOCATIONS & EXPANSIONS

Companies drawn to Cleveland not for raw data center access, but because Burke creates the talent density and infrastructure signals that drive location decisions.

#	Company	Why They Are a Target	Burke Campus Hook
19	Salesforce	Existing Cleveland presence; Health Cloud deeply deployed at Cleveland Clinic; growing Midwest enterprise customer base.	<i>Burke campus as compute anchor plus Cleveland Clinic's Salesforce Health Cloud deployments creates a logical case for a significant Cleveland AI engineering hub expansion.</i>
20	Accenture / Deloitte AI Practices	Both consulting giants expanding AI delivery centers in lower-cost Midwest cities; Cleveland has healthcare AI depth, industrial opportunity, and now Burke campus infrastructure.	<i>Cheaper than Chicago, more credentialed than Columbus. Burke is the tipping point that makes Cleveland the obvious Midwest AI delivery center location.</i>
21	Scale AI / Weights & Biases / Hugging Face	AI infrastructure and tooling companies that sell to enterprise customers need proximity to those customers' compute.	<i>If Microsoft, Oracle, AWS, and Equinix all run workloads at Burke, the AI tooling layer follows. Cleveland engineering offices serve their largest Midwest enterprise accounts.</i>

The Compounding Effect

The most important dynamic is not any single company — it is the clustering effect that Burke creates. Each tenant tier reinforces the next, building a self-sustaining technology ecosystem that compounds in value over decades.

- 01 SMR + Lake Erie cooling delivers cheapest 24/7 clean compute in the Midwest
- 02 Hyperscalers anchor the campus — Microsoft, Oracle, AWS, Google
- 03 Healthcare AI companies co-locate for Cleveland Clinic proximity
- 04 Industrial AI companies follow their Ohio manufacturing customers
- 05 AI talent density grows — startups form, venture capital follows
- 06 Corporate HQ relocations follow the talent
- 07 Cleveland becomes the Great Lakes AI Capital

Cleveland's cost of living advantage, Cleveland Clinic and University Hospitals anchor partnerships, and the growing university talent pipeline already exist. Burke accelerates these assets into a self-reinforcing loop that no competing Midwest city can replicate — because no competing city has Lake Erie cooling, an SMR campus, and a world-ranked health system on the same doorstep.

Burke doesn't follow the Meta/Oklo Pike County template. Done right, it surpasses it — and becomes the national model that data center campuses everywhere else copy next.